

This link takes you to `/auth/facebook` as required by Omniauth, after which Omniauth redirects you to Facebook, which then takes care of authenticating you, and returns a response message on the callback URL `/auth/facebook/callback`. This callback URL needs to be configured in routes for all providers:

```
# events/config/routes.rb
map.connect '/auth/:provider/callback', :controller => 'user_
sessions', :action => 'social_session_create'
```

The response that you get from Facebook is an OAuth response, and will contain a UID field which denotes the user's unique OAuth ID at Facebook and a provider field (set to `facebook`), besides other fields like name, email, etc. Let's create a new model to store the key fields, along with an additional `user_id` field to map it to your `User` model:

```
script/generate model authorization provider:string uid:string
user_id:integer
```

This will generate `authorization.rb`, and you need to associate it with your `User` model by adding a `has_one` association as follows:

```
# events/app/models/authorization.rb
has_one :user, :primary_key => "user_id", :foreign_key => "id"
```

For external authentication, handle the session creation differently in the `UserSessionsController`. Use a new method, `create_social_session`:

```
# events/app/controllers/user_sessions_controller.rb
# create_social_session
# get the auth response from the request
@auth_response = request.env['rack.auth']
# Check if the user has an existing social profile
# (in the Authorization model - match on uid, provider)
@auth = Authorization.find_from_hash(@auth_response)
# if the user doesn't have a social profile then nil is
returned
if @auth.nil?
  # Create a new user or add an authorization to an existing
  user
  @auth = Authorization.create_from_hash(@auth_response)
end
# Log-in the authorizing user with remember me as false
@user_session = UserSession.create(@auth.user, false)
if @user_session.save
  flash[:notice] = "Successfully logged in."
  redirect_to root_url
else
  flash[:notice] = "Login failed!"
  render :action => 'new'
end
```

We will not discuss authorisation methods, as they are simple CRUD methods on either the *Authorization* model or the *User* model. The gist of this code is that you need to extract and process the response from Facebook.

That's it! You now have Facebook Connect for your application. Who would have thought that it could be so simple? Thanks to the people at Intridea who came up with this wonderful plug-in! Read more about Omniauth at <https://github.com/intridea/omniauth>.

JRails plug-in

Rails, by default, uses the Prototype JavaScript library. When a new Rails project is created, the following files will be present in the `events/public/javascripts/` directory:

- `prototype.js`
- `effects.js`
- `dragdrop.js`
- `controls.js`

The last three are *script.aculo.us* libraries. If you wish to use jQuery instead, don't worry, jRails comes to the rescue. This plug-in lets you use your favourite JS library, jQuery, instead of Prototype. It includes the jQuery equivalent (`jquery.js` and `jquery-ui.js`) of the above four files in your app. jRails will allow your app to use the Rails JavaScript helpers by calling jQuery functions.

Installation

Install the plugin from github:

```
script/plugin install https://github.com/aaronchi/jrails.git
```

Usage

Adding the following helper to the view will include `jquery.js` and `jquery-ui.js` in the HTML:

```
# e.g. events/app/views/events/new.html.erb
<%= javascript_include_tag :defaults %>
```

Now you can include any jQuery library and call the functions through the available Rails helpers, or pure JavaScript code. To know more about jRails, go to <https://github.com/aaronchi/jrails/wiki>.

Well, the next time you think of a feature for your Rails app, just Google around, there could be an existing plug-in for it! It'll save you a lot of time... 

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